

# UI/UX Audit Rulebook

Check off each rule to track compliance. Use with your agent for review.

Overall compliance

0 / 62

● Must — blocking   ● Should — recommended   ● Nice — enhancement

- All
- Must
- Should
- Nice
- Done
- To do

Layout & Structure

0 / 8

☐ Consistent grid system used throughout (8px or 4px base unit)

must

☐ Page has clear visual hierarchy: primary → secondary → tertiary elements

must

☐ Content max-width is defined and respected (typically 960–1280px)

must

☐ Logical reading order: top-to-bottom, left-to-right (LTR layouts)

must

☐ No orphaned elements floating without spatial context

should

☐ Sections are visually separated with consistent spacing (not random margins)

should

☐ Sidebar or navigation does not overlap main content at any breakpoint

must

☐ Z-index layers are intentional and documented (modal > tooltip > header > content)

should

Typography

0 / 8

☐ Font scale is defined: H1, H2, H3, body, caption — not arbitrary sizes

must

☐ Line-height for body text is between 1.5 and 1.75

must

☐ Maximum line length (measure) is 65–80 characters for long-form text

should

☐ No more than 2 typefaces used in the UI

should

☐ Font weights are intentional: regular for body, medium/bold for emphasis only

should

☐ Text never gets clipped or truncated without a visible indicator (...)

must

☐ All caps usage limited to labels/badges only, never body copy

should

☐ Heading hierarchy is semantic (h1 > h2 > h3) and not skipped

must

## 🔘 Color & Contrast

0 / 8 ▼

☐ Text on background meets WCAG AA contrast ratio (4.5:1 normal, 3:1 large text)

must

☐ Color is never the sole indicator of meaning (always paired with icon or text)

must

☐ A consistent color system is defined (primary, secondary, semantic, neutral)

must

☐ Interactive elements have distinct states: default / hover / active / disabled

must

☐ Dark mode (if applicable) uses inverted ramps, not just CSS filter:invert()

should

☐ Brand accent color is used sparingly — not on every element

should

☐ Error red, warning amber, success green are reserved for status only

must

☐ No pure #000 on pure #FFF — slightly off-white/off-black reduces harshness

nice

## ↔ Spacing & Density

0 / 7 ▼

☐ All spacing values come from the design system scale (4, 8, 12, 16, 24, 32, 48px...)

must

☐ Touch targets are at least 44×44px on mobile

must

☐ Related elements are grouped closer than unrelated ones (Gestalt proximity)

must

☐ Cards and containers have consistent internal padding

should

☐ Density is adapted to context: data tables tight, reading views generous

should

☐ Form labels are close to their input, not floating between two fields

must

☐ Page sections have sufficient vertical rhythm — no two sections feel cramped

should

## 🔘 Components & Consistency

0 / 9 ▼

☐ Buttons have a clear visual priority: primary, secondary, ghost/text

must

☐ Icons are from a single icon set; no mixing of different styles

should

☐ Form inputs: same height, same border-radius, same focus ring throughout

must

- ☐ Modals/dialogs have a clear close affordance (X button + ESC key) **must**
- ☐ Tables have visible row separators or alternating rows for scannability **should**
- ☐ Tooltips trigger on hover and appear within viewport — never clipped **should**
- ☐ Loading states defined: skeleton screens or spinners, no blank white flash **must**
- ☐ Empty states are designed: icon + message + CTA, not just a blank container **should**
- ☐ Destructive actions (delete, remove) require confirmation before execution **must**

## ← Feedback & States

0 / 7 ▼

- ☐ Every user action has visible feedback within 100ms (hover state at minimum) **must**
- ☐ Error messages are specific and actionable — not just 'Something went wrong' **must**
- ☐ Success confirmations are shown and disappear automatically (toast/banner) **should**
- ☐ Long operations show progress (progress bar, percentage, or ETA) **should**
- ☐ Disabled UI elements explain why they are disabled (tooltip or helper text) **should**
- ☐ Form validation runs on blur (not only on submit) for immediate feedback **should**
- ☐ Network errors are caught and shown to the user — no silent failures **must**

## ⬡ Responsiveness & Breakpoints

0 / 7 ▼

- ☐ Layout tested at 375px (mobile), 768px (tablet), 1280px (desktop) at minimum **must**
- ☐ No horizontal scroll on mobile (except data tables with intentional overflow) **must**
- ☐ Navigation collapses to mobile-friendly pattern below 768px **must**
- ☐ Images are responsive (max-width: 100%, aspect-ratio preserved) **must**
- ☐ Font sizes do not shrink below 14px on mobile **must**
- ☐ Tap targets re-evaluated on mobile: minimum 44px, not just visually scaled down **must**
- ☐ Modals become bottom sheets or full-screen on mobile if content is long **nice**

## ☉ Accessibility

0 / 8 ▼

- ☐ All images have descriptive alt text; decorative images use alt="" **must**
- ☐ Keyboard navigation works: Tab, Shift+Tab, Enter, Escape all function correctly **must**
- ☐ Focus ring is always visible — never removed without a replacement style **must**
- ☐ ARIA roles/labels added where native HTML semantics are insufficient **should**
- ☐ Skip-to-main-content link is available at the top of each page **should**
- ☐ Animations respect prefers-reduced-motion media query **should**
- ☐ Form fields are associated with labels via for/id or aria-label **must**
- ☐ Color-blind safe palette verified with a simulation tool **nice**